Temperate Zone

From the Tropic of Cancer (23½°N) to the Arctic Circle (66½°N) and from the Tropic of Capricorn (23½°S) to the Antarctic Circle (66½°S), the Sun's rays fall slantingly. Moderate temperature prevails in this region. Hence, this region is called **Temperate Zone.**

Frigid Zone

From the Arctic Circle (66½°N) to the North Pole (90⁰N) and from the Antarctic Circle (66½°S) to the South Pole (90°S), the Sun's rays fall further inclined, through out the year. The temperature is very low. Hence, this region is known as **Frigid Zone.**

DO YOU KNOW?

Some lines of latitude are also called by the following names in Tamil.

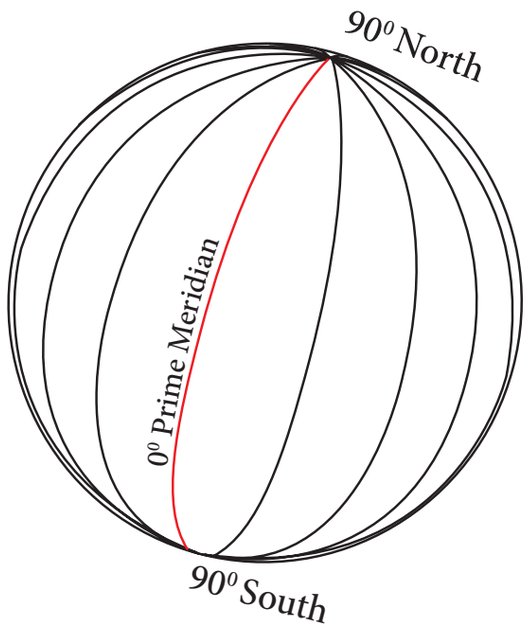
Latitude	-	ahalangu (அகலாங்கு)
Longitude	-	nettangu (நெட்டாங்கு)
Equator	-	nilanaduvarai (நிலநடுவரை)
Tropic of Cancer	-	kadagavarai (கடகவரை)
Tropic of Capricorn	-	magaravarai (மகரவரை)

(Source: Ariviyal Kalanjiyam, The Tamil University)

Longitudes

The imaginary lines drawn vertically connecting the North Pole and the South Pole are called lines or meridians of longitude. These lines of longitude are seen as semi circles.

The 0° line of longitude is called the **Prime Meridian**. There are 180 lines of longitude towards the East and West from the Prime Meridian. So, there are totally **360 lines of longitude**. These lines converge at the poles. The 180° W and 180° E line of longitude are the same line.



The lines of longitude that are found between the Prime Meridian and the 180° East line of longitude are called **'Eastern Longitudes'** and the lines of longitude that are found between the Prime Meridian (0°) and the 180° West line of longitude are called **'Western Longitudes'**. Two opposite meridians form a great circle

DO YOU KNOW?

The lines of longitude are found as semi circles covering 111 km at the Equator, 79 km at 45° latitude and no space between the lines at the poles.

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